The Jungle Newsroom

The daily

what's moving on social

THINGS WE SAW

- Just Eat's AI menu photos get ridiculed, then paused
- Harry Kane wins the Ballon d'Or in London, after a website leak
- “Maxxing” is Dictionary.com's Word of the Year
- Asda's custard-cream chocolate bar gets the “M&S-coded” treatment
- TikTok's “brain stacking” trend swaps scrolling for books and puzzles

PLATFORM HIGHLIGHTS

- Instagram tests 90-minute videos with select US creators
- Meta pushes its business terms update back to 20 Nov

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Fading | UK | Reddit, Instagram & X

Just Eat's AI menu photos get ridiculed, then paused

Just Eat's AI-made dish photos went viral: bacon-and-egg soda bread became a glass of cola with an egg and bacon in it, and garlic bread became a plane. Just Eat said “We're sorry for any inaccurate images that have been posted”, is removing them and has paused the rollout.

> **Why it matters:** AI-made food photos got ridiculed fast. The gap between the picture and the real dish became the joke.

Dexerto, 23 Oct (citing the BBC and The Journal) · Image: Dexerto / Just Eat

dexerto.com/food/just-eat-apologizes-after-ai-turns-food-i...

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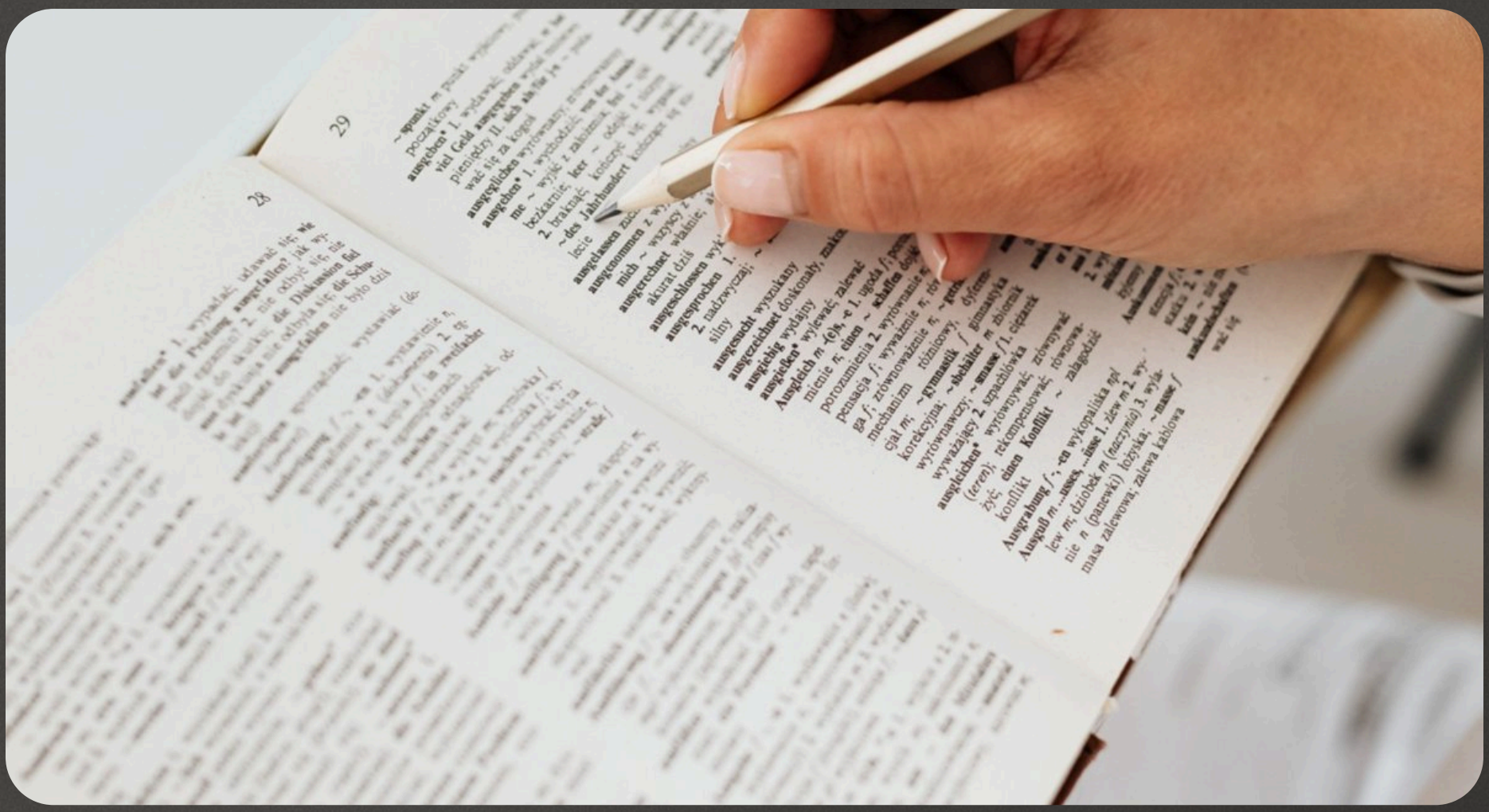
Peaking | UK | X

Harry Kane wins the Ballon d'Or in London, after a website leak

Harry Kane won on Monday, the first Englishman since Michael Owen in 2001. Hours earlier the awards website wrongly published articles naming Kane, Kylian Mbappé and Lamine Yamal each as winner. Organisers said the profiles were “inadvertently published”.

> **Why it matters:** A British winner and an accidental leak gave people two reasons to post: the celebration and the jokes.

LADbible, 26 Oct; ESPN, 26 Oct · Image: Getty via LADbible
ladbible.com/news/sport/harry-kane-wins-ballon-d-or-becomi...



Rising | Global | TikTok & X

“Maxxing” is Dictionary.com's Word of the Year

Dictionary.com picked “maxxing”: pursuing an activity to the fullest or optimising an aspect of your life. Offshoots include looksmaxxing, cozymaxxing (at-home relaxing) and nonnamaxxing, the habits of an Italian grandmother.

> **Why it matters:** A ready-made template for brands: “[thing]-maxxing”. Cozymaxxing suits the dark evenings.

Dexerto, 26 Oct (citing Dictionary.com) · Image: Dictionary.com via Dexerto
dexerto.com/entertainment/maxxing-named-2026-word-of-the-y...

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Rising | UK | Facebook & Instagram

Asda's custard-cream bar gets the "M&S-coded" treatment

Asda launched a £2 milk chocolate bar with a custard-cream filling, plus a jammy donut version and Malted Choc Balls, which Metro links to M&S's Malt Ball. Some shoppers pointed out that Morrisons already sells a £2 custard-cream bar.

> **Why it matters:** Supermarkets copy each other in public and shoppers score it in the comments. Low stakes, lots of replies.

Metro, 26 Oct · Image: Metro
metro.co.uk/2026/10/26/asda-launches-new-items-rival-m-s-i...



Rising | Global | TikTok

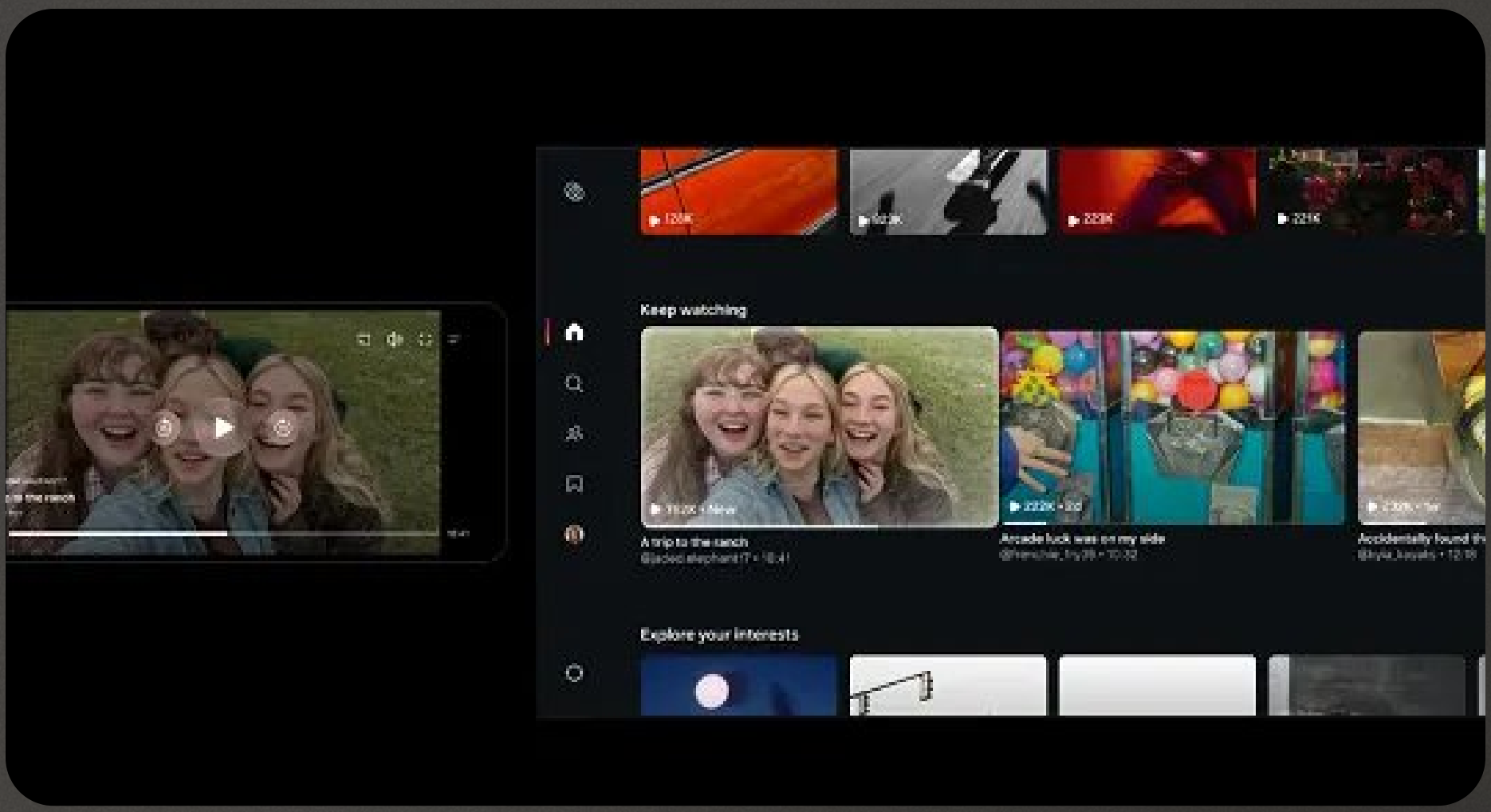
TikTok's "brain stacking" swaps scrolling for books and puzzles

Creators on TikTok and Reels keep a "stack" of books, Sudoku, crosswords and journals within reach to replace scrolling, often in morning and bedtime routines. Mashable says the origin of the term is unclear.

> **Why it matters:** Anti-scroll content on the platforms people scroll. Cosy, screen-free routines suit the dark evenings.

Mashable, 21 Oct · Image: Mashable
mashable.com/life/brain-stacking-analog-trend-explained

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Rising · Global · Instagram

Instagram tests 90-minute videos with US creators

Instagram has begun testing “Features”: uploads of up to 90 minutes, such as podcasts and vlogs, with select US creators. Creators can link Reels clips to the full video, and it isn't exclusive to Instagram. No UK date has been given.

> **Why it matters:** Instagram is going after long-form video. Don't plan around it in the UK yet.

Social Media Today, 26 Oct · Image: Instagram via Social Media Today
socialmediatoday.com/news/instagram-rolls-out-limited-feat...

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Peaking | UK | Facebook & Instagram

Meta pushes back its business terms update to 20 Nov

Meta has moved its updated business terms from 30 Oct to 20 Nov, after the UK's CMA and the European Publishers Council asked about wording on scraping and training. Meta says it's largely a misunderstanding and removed the “training” references last week.

> **Why it matters:** Anything planned around 30 Oct can wait. The new date comes from Social Media Today, citing Reuters.

Social Media Today, 25 Oct · Image: Meta via Social Media Today
socialmediatoday.com/news/meta-delays-business-terms-updat...

Things to watch this week

Now

October half-term, until Fri 30 Oct

Family days out and at-home plans fill feeds. Keep weather jokes out after the weekend storms.

Wed 28 Oct

Instagram removes Reels series links

Check any posts or plans that rely on linking Reels in a series.

Thu 29–Fri 30 Oct

Celebrity Traitors' last two episodes

Reported for 8pm on BBC One. Expect the conversation to peak on Friday night.

Sat 31 Oct

Halloween, and Strictly's Halloween special

Costume and Halloween content peaks from Thursday. Get posts out early.

Fri 20 Nov

Meta's business terms update (moved from 30 Oct)

Per Social Media Today, citing Reuters. Meta says the scraping concern is a misunderstanding.

For Disney UK

Pip · Disney UK desk

IDEA · HEXED

Carve Hexed's 27 November date into a pumpkin.

A Halloween hook that uses only the confirmed cinema date.

IDEA · HALF-TERM

A “never seen it” challenge: one classic Disney film each night.

Use titles already out. No release or cast promises.

WATCH OUT

Post confirmed facts only: no Hexed plot, and nothing on Glee beyond the announcement.

For Disney Family UK

Bo · Disney Family UK desk

IDEA · BRAIN STACKING

A half-term swap: a basket of books and puzzles beside the sofa.

Ties the trend to half-term. Don't claim it helps focus.

IDEA · CLOCKS WENT BACK

A cosy film-night plan for early-dark teatimes.

Dark evenings are the hook. A family plan, not a product push.

WATCH OUT

Keep content free of scary Halloween imagery for under-fives, and don't frame screens as a reward.

For Disney Store UK

Lulu · Disney Store UK desk

IDEA · HALLOWEEN

Last-minute Halloween: three costume picks for Saturday night.

Post by Friday, since Halloween is Saturday itself.

IDEA · COZYMAXXING

Cozymaxxing: a plush-and-blanket corner for dark evenings.

Pairs the word with the clocks going back. No sleep claims.

WATCH OUT

Costume and plush posts only. Show age labels, keep scares light, and make no unsafe-costume jokes.

For Mutti UK

Kiki · Mutti UK desk

IDEA · AI MENU PHOTOS

Photo vs pan: cook a real Mutti dish live, unretouched.

Show the process, not a render. Don't name any other brand.

IDEA · NONNAMAXXING

Nonnamaxxing: cook like an Italian grandmother, passata from the jar.

The word's own definition is an Italian grandmother's habits. Food first.

WATCH OUT

Use only real, unedited food shots. An AI-made image risks the same joke on us.

For Optimum Nutrition UK

Rex · Optimum Nutrition UK desk

IDEA · MAXXING

Maxxing your gym week: plan three half-term sessions and share the plan.

Frames training habits only. No results or body claims.

IDEA · BRAIN STACKING

A phone-free session: leave the phone in the locker and log it in a notebook.

Echoes the trend. Real members only, no results claims.

WATCH OUT

Teens may be in gyms at half-term. No supplement content aimed at under-18s, and no before-and-after framing.

For DFS

Dot · DFS desk

IDEA · COZYMAXXING

Cozymaxxing: build the sofa corner for at-home relaxing.

Show real, lived-in rooms, not staged wellbeing claims.

IDEA · BRAIN STACKING

A brain-stack corner: a sofa-side basket of puzzles and books.

Show the basket, not a claimed benefit.

WATCH OUT

No claims that furniture improves sleep, focus or wellbeing.

Did we miss something?

Spotted something we missed? Or want more of something tomorrow? Reply under this post in #agency-hq.

See the newsroom island →

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